

its engagement with Google on the Android operating system. Apache is caught between the ongoing fight between Oracle and Google over patent infringement related to Java. Oracle has even asked Apache to submit documents related to a failed bid made by ASF to acquire a licence for Java SE.

RIM opens enterprise servers to rivals

RIM has decided to open its highly secure enterprise servers to its rivals' (Apple and Android) smartphones. It has offered to manage communications sent over rival devices and ease IT department concerns about leakage of confidential information, since RIM boasts of its security features in BlackBerry. This change comes after companies have been increasingly allowing employees to access corporate data from Apple's iPhone and iPad, or Google's Android-based devices.

OpenGamma now open sourced

OpenGamma, a provider of analytics software for the financial services industry, has been developing a unified platform for financial analytics to help financial services firms combine their data management, calculation engines and analysis into a single framework. The platform, which is still in development, has now been released as an open source developer preview.

The preview, dual-licensed under an Apache 2.0 licence or a commercial licence, is described as a "beta-quality release" that has been through OpenGamma's testing and QA processes. "We consider this a developer preview primarily because we don't think that you can download the source code, install it, and have an end-user-friendly application in the first few hours of experience. This is our goal, and while we're working actively towards it, using this release will require custom programming and file-level configuration to have an end-user-friendly application," the developers noted.

Yahoo! joins Linux Foundation

The Linux Foundation has announced Yahoo! as its new member. By joining the foundation, the company can maximise its investment in Linux while directly supporting the Linux community's developer and legal efforts. Yahoo! will contribute to the foundation's working groups and initiatives focused on virtualisation, cloud computing and legal topics, such as open compliance. The company will also participate in Linux Foundation events, including the Linux Foundation End User Summit where it will interact with Linux kernel developers and other open source software experts.



Skype for Android plays privacy flaw

Skype has announced a new version of the Skype for Android application, which contains a fix to the vulnerability, reported recently, that could have allowed a malicious third-party application to access locally stored files. According to a post on the Skype Security blog, these files include cached profile information and instant messages. The updated smartphone software also enables calling over 3G for all users, including those in the US – this feature was previously unavailable.



Ubuntu targets 200 million users in four years

Canonical aims to have 200 million Ubuntu users by 2015. Mark Shuttleworth, the founder of open source support firm Canonical, made the prediction at the Ubuntu Developer Summit in Budapest, Hungary.



"[Our] goal is 200 million users of Ubuntu in four years," he said, adding, "We're not playing a game for developers' hearts and minds – we're playing a game for the world's hearts and minds. And to do that, we need to play by a new set of rules."

There's no official data from the company about how many Ubuntu users are there right now. But last year, a Canonical employee estimated that Ubuntu had around 12 million users globally.

Nokia to release Qt 5 in 2012

Lars Knoll, director of R&D at Nokia, recently announced in a blog post that Qt 5, the next generation of the Qt cross-platform application and UI framework, will be released in 2012—seven years since the release of Qt 4.0 in 2005. The plan is to have a beta release somewhere at the end of 2011.

The developers have laid out a number of goals for Qt 5 to make better use of GPUs for smoother animated graphics while also making the creation of complex applications easier through the use of QML and JavaScript. The developers say they also want all Qt applications deeply Web connected to make them "as powerful as possible". Finally, they hope to reduce the complexity in porting and maintaining a port of Qt on new platforms.